Waleed Albadawi

ENTERPRISE TECHNOLOGY EXECUTIVE

VP, Enterprise Integration · The Saudi Investment Bank · Riyadh

Tech100
STRATEGIC LEADER OF THE FUTURE
SAUDI ARABIA EDITION

+966 58 229 3134 • walidkhb@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/walidkhb • www.wbadawi.info

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

I build institutional technology capability, not just systems. Over **14 years in Saudi banking and government** I have moved from writing integration code to running the function every channel, payment rail, regulator and partner of a bank depends on. In seven years at The Saudi Investment Bank I progressed from senior developer to vice president by leaving something permanent behind each time: an **API business worth 8% of annual profit**, a **Digital Factory** that changed how the bank ships software, and a **governed platform across 50+ systems** that cut time-to-market by 70%. I combine board-level judgement on strategy, risk and vendors with the architectural depth to challenge any design in the room, and I am ready for enterprise-wide technology leadership.

14+	40+	8%	4	5
YEARS IN ENTERPRISE TECHNOLOGY	PEOPLE LED TODAY	ANNUAL PROFIT FROM API STRATEGY	PROMOTIONS IN 7 YEARS	ARCHITECTURE AND CLOUD CERTIFICATIONS

THE LAST 24 MONTHS 2024 – 2026

70%
FASTER TIME-TO-MARKET

Integration became a platform

New products and partners now launch on one governed platform spanning 50+ systems, instead of a bespoke build every time.

100%
REGULATOR CONFORMANCE IN SANDBOX

Open Banking as a platform

Built the bank's Open Banking capability in-house: full conformance with the SAMA test suites in sandbox, certification under way, and a foundation for fintech partnerships.

5
PAYMENT RAILS MODERNISED

Payments modernisation

Led integration of the bank's new payment hub, bringing instant payments, SARIE, SADAD, bulk and request-to-pay onto one controlled path into core banking.

De-risked
CORE BANKING DEPENDENCY

Core banking opened up

Turned the core system from a delivery bottleneck into reusable, governed services, so programmes build and test in parallel and core change carries less risk.

35%
FRAUD RISK REDUCED

Preventing fraud in real time

Moved the bank from investigating fraud after the fact to stopping it in real time, without slowing customer payments.

Audit-ready
EVERY RELEASE TRACEABLE

Delivery with built-in control

Replaced manual, people-dependent releases with automated, fully traceable delivery that has security and compliance checks built in.

1
BANK-WIDE STANDARD

Governance that accelerates

Authored the integration standard the bank and its vendors now build to, with clear decision gates, and made it part of technology sourcing.

12+
PROGRAMMES DELIVERED

Regulatory and business delivery

Delivered across SAMA enforcement, treasury, credit bureau, escrow and retail banking, each one reusing the shared platform rather than starting again.

LEADERSHIP PROGRESSION

The Saudi Investment Bank
Riyadh · 2018 – Present

VP, Enterprise Integration
JUN 2025 – PRESENT

Head of Integration · leading a team of 40+ and reporting to technology leadership

- **Own the enterprise integration strategy** across core banking, digital channels, regulatory interfaces and partner ecosystems, with a multi-year modernisation roadmap.
- **Built the operating model** for a 40+ organisation: clear ownership, accountable leaders and delivery governance that lets the bank move fast with full auditability.
- **Shape sourcing decisions:** set the standards and service levels vendors are held to in managed-services and transformation sourcing.
- **Reduce institutional risk:** led an architecture and security review of the corporate internet banking estate, giving executive management a prioritised remediation plan.

Acting Head of Integration
SEP 2023 – JUN 2025

Integration platform, digital product launches, regulatory programmes

- Launched **two consumer digital banking products** on a shared backbone connecting 15+ backend systems with sub-second response.
- Delivered **real-time transaction monitoring**, cutting fraud risk by 35%.

Digital Services Manager
APR 2021 – AUG 2023

Founder of the Digital Factory, reporting to C-level

- Built a **new unit of 25** engineers, analysts and project managers and moved it from waterfall to continuous delivery.
- Shipped the bank's **first microservices application**; its DevSecOps practices became the standard for all new development.

Integration Manager
DEC 2019 – APR 2021

Enterprise integration platform and API strategy

- Designed and launched the bank's **API monetisation strategy** (partner platform, developer ecosystem, tiered pricing): a new revenue stream contributing 8% to annual profit.

Senior Integration Developer
JUL 2018 – DEC 2019

- Led the **zero-downtime migration** of the bank's legacy integration platform with 100% service continuity.

BUILT FOR THE ORGANISATION

Ownership. Integration moved from a service-request queue to a funded platform with its own roadmap.

Knowledge. An engineering handbook and knowledge base, so capability no longer depends on individuals.

Operations. Service dashboards, vendor SLA views and escalation playbooks for the operations centre.

Vendors. Bank-defined integration standards and service levels applied to sourcing and vendors.

EARLIER CAREER

Senior Integration Developer · *Zenith, Riyadh* — OCT 2017 – JUN 2018

Senior Integration Developer · *ELM, Riyadh (Absher platform)* — DEC 2014 – SEP 2017

Senior Software Engineer · *Arabian Centres, Saudi Arabia* — MAY 2014 – DEC 2014

Software Engineer · *SSSProcess, Jordan* — JUL 2012 – APR 2014

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Software Engineering · *Al-Balqa Applied University, Jordan* — 2012

EXECUTIVE CAPABILITIES

- **Enterprise technology strategy** and multi-year roadmaps aligned to Vision 2030
- **Platform strategy** and architecture governance
- **Operating model** and organisational design for teams of 25 to 40+
- **Digital and ecosystem enablement:** API economy, Open Banking, Banking-as-a-Service
- **Risk, control and regulatory alignment:** SAMA, PCI DSS, PDPL
- **Vendor, sourcing** and managed-service governance
- **Board and C-level** communication

TECHNOLOGY DEPTH

INTEGRATION AND API
IBM Cloud Pak for Integration, App Connect, MQ, API Connect / DataPower

STREAMING AND DATA
Kafka, Kafka Streams, Flink, Debezium, Redis

CLOUD AND PLATFORM
OpenShift, Kubernetes, Argo CD, Tekton, GitLab CI, Helm, Vault, AWS, Azure

SECURITY
FAPI 2.0, OAuth 2.1, OIDC, mTLS, Zero Trust

PAYMENTS
ISO 20022, SARIE, SADAD, mada, IPS, SWIFT MT / MX

ENGINEERING
Java, Spring Boot, Node.js, Python

CERTIFICATIONS

- IBM Certified Solution Architect, Cloud Pak for Integration
- IBM Certified Integration Developer
- Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)
- ISO 27001 Lead Implementer

RECOGNITION

Tech100: Strategic Leader of the Future, Saudi Arabia Edition.

LANGUAGES

Arabic native · **English** professional